

PRODUCT-001

The Opus X Design System —
Visual Identity, Design
Philosophy, and Product
Experience

ADOPTED

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NOTE — Position and authority of this document. PRODUCT-001 is the official visual and experiential reference of the Opus X ecosystem. It is the companion to PRODUCT-000: where the philosophy states *why* the product exists and what it must feel like, this document states *what it looks like and how it is built*. Every mockup, component, screen, dashboard, and application in the ecosystem conforms to it.

Register of normativity. This document is **normative within the design register**: where it uses capitalized keywords (MUST, MUST NOT, SHOULD, MAY), they bind design and front-end implementation. It creates **no protocol requirement** and relaxes **no protocol invariant**; the protocol's rules remain owned by WSP/MODEL/FOUNDATION, and this document is bound by them (§2.4). It evolves only through controlled versioning.

Version History

Version	Date	Status	Summary of Changes
1.0	2026-07-12	Draft for Adoption	Initial publication. Establishes the brand identity, visual DNA, palette, typography, logo system, iconography, component library, dashboard principles, Passport presentation, trust visualization, AI experience, motion, imagery, and the founding design principles. Adopts <i>Design follows Trust</i> as the governing principle.
1.1	2026-07-13	Adopted	Chapter 7 (The Logo System) rewritten to record the adopted mark — the X within a broken circle, in gold and silver. Section 5.3 amended with the bounded exception : the brand mark may carry gold; the interface may not. Records the critical distinction between the logo (a fixed brand artifact) and the seal (the product's mark of earned trust) — they are different marks with different rules. No change to any other rule; the gold discipline of the interface (§5.3, §14) is untouched and remains absolute.

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Part I — Foundations

1. Purpose and Authority

1.1 Purpose

This document defines a visual identity intended to last for decades. Its ambition is not to be current; it is to be **timeless** — to hold the same authority in twenty years as on the day it is published, the way the visual languages of Apple, Stripe, Visa, Bloomberg, Notion, and Linear have held theirs. We seek their level of perceived quality, restraint, and permanence; we copy none of them.

1.2 Authority

From its adoption, every mockup, component, screen, dashboard, and application in the Opus X ecosystem conforms to this document. It is the reference for designers, front-end engineers, AI systems producing interfaces, all PRODUCT documents, and every partner building on the platform.

1.3 Scope

The visual identity, design philosophy, and interface system of the ecosystem. Out of scope: the product philosophy (PRODUCT-000, which this serves), the experience of specific surfaces (PRODUCT-100-900), the protocol and its invariants (WSP/MODEL/FOUNDATION, which bind this document), and brand copy (governed by the locked lexicon, §19.3).

1.4 Prerequisites

PRODUCT-000 (the product philosophy), OPUS-000 (the platform's three pillars), FOUNDATION-000 (the invariants this system makes visible), and ARCH-001 (*Evidence Is Produced. Trust Is Verified.*).

2. Brand Identity

2.1 Mission

To give every professional a verifiable, portable, lifelong representation of what they can actually do — and to give the world a way to trust it.

2.2 Vision

That understanding what a person can do means consulting an infrastructure, not guessing from a résumé. Opus X is the trusted third party of professional competence: invisible, indispensable, and permanent.

2.3 Positioning

Opus X **MUST NOT** be perceived as: a trading platform, an EdTech product, a startup, a crypto product, or an LMS.

Opus X **MUST** be perceived as: a **global infrastructure**, a **trusted third party**, a **premium technology platform**, an **institutional reference**, and a **professional standard**.

Every visual decision is tested against this. If a treatment would be at home on a crypto exchange, a gamified learning app, or a growth-stage SaaS landing page, it is wrong here — regardless of how well it performs elsewhere.

2.4 Values Made Visible

Six values must be legible in every screen:

Trust · Precision · Transparency · Professionalism · Evidence · Clarity

These are not adjectives for a brand deck; they are testable properties of an interface. *Transparency* means an index can be opened to the evidence beneath it. *Evidence* means a fact is visually distinguishable from an interpretation. *Precision* means a number is never decorative. The visual system is how the protocol's invariants become something a person can see (§14.6).

2.5 Personality

Institutional, not corporate. Confident, not loud. Precise, not clinical. Calm, not cold. Opus X speaks the way a central bank, a national archive, or a supreme court speaks: quietly, with the assumption of permanence.

3. The Design Principles

Five principles govern every decision. When they conflict with convenience, novelty, or conversion, they win.

- 1. Design follows Trust.** Every graphic choice must reinforce the credibility of the Professional Passport. Beauty that does not serve trust is decoration, and decoration is subtracted.
- 2. Clarity before Complexity.** The interface shows the truest thing, clearly, before it shows everything. Density is not seriousness.
- 3. Evidence before Opinion.** What was demonstrated outranks what is inferred, always — in position, in weight, in visual authority.
- 4. Professionalism before Marketing.** The product never persuades. It states. Nothing in the interface exists to convert.
- 5. Precision before Decoration.** Every line, weight, and pixel is load-bearing. If an element can be removed without loss of meaning, it **MUST** be removed.

4. Visual DNA

The identity rests on four material qualities:

- **Deep navy as the dominant.** Not black (which reads as luxury-fashion or crypto), not grey (which reads as enterprise software). Navy is the colour of institutions, of ink, of night skies and archival bindings. It carries gravity without aggression.
 - **Gold, reserved and scarce.** Gold appears **only** for trust, certification, verification, and the Passport's seal. It is never a brand accent, never a button colour, never decoration. Its scarcity is precisely what gives it authority: when gold appears, something has been *earned*.
 - **Generous white space.** Space is not emptiness; it is confidence. A cramped interface signals a product that has something to prove. Opus X does not.
 - **Minimalism as restraint, not as fashion.** We remove because meaning is clearer without, not because minimalism is current.
-

Part II — The Visual System

5. Colour

5.1 The Principle of Colour

Colour in Opus X is **semantic, never decorative**. Every colour carries meaning. A designer **MUST NOT** introduce a colour for visual interest; a colour is introduced only when it says something a colourless treatment could not.

5.2 Primary — Opus Navy

The dominant. Used for the Passport object, institutional surfaces, primary text, and structural authority.

Token	Hex	Use
navy-950	#050B15	The Passport's deepest ground; ceremony backgrounds
navy-900	#0A1628	Object surfaces; the Passport's material
navy-800	#0F2038	Raised object surfaces
navy-700	#16304F	Object borders; structural lines
navy-600	#1E4272	Core brand navy — the signature colour
navy-500	#2C5892	Interactive navy; primary actions in the Tool register
navy-400	#5081BC	Secondary interactive
navy-300	#8FB0D8	Supporting elements
navy-200	#C2D6EC	Subtle fills
navy-100	#E4EDF7	Tinted backgrounds
navy-50	#F4F8FC	The lightest institutional wash

5.3 Accent — Opus Gold

Gold is the colour of earned trust. It is the most disciplined element of this system.

Token	Hex	Use
gold-700	#8A6D2F	Gold text on light surfaces (contrast-safe)
gold-600	#A88A42	Dimmed seal; secondary trust marks
gold-500	#C9A961	The seal. Certifications, verification, the Passport's mark

Token	Hex	Use
gold-400	#DDC489	Gold on dark surfaces; engraved highlights
gold-300	#EBDCB4	Subtle trust tint
gold-100	#F7F1E2	Trust-tinted background (rare)

Rules for gold — normative:

- Gold **MUST** be reserved for: certifications, verified evidence, the Passport's seal, and trust reaching a meaningful threshold.
- Gold **MUST NOT** be used for: primary buttons, navigation, links, brand headers, hover states, charts (except a verified series), or any decorative purpose.
- Gold **MUST NOT** occupy more than approximately **2% of any screen's visible area**. Its power is its scarcity.
- Gold **MUST NOT** be used to signal an *interpretation*. Gold marks what is *proven* (§14.6).

The bounded exception — the brand mark. The Opus X logo carries gold (§7). This is the **single** exception, and it is bounded precisely so that it does not erode the discipline:

- The logo is a **fixed artifact**, drawn once. The interface is **generated**, continuously. Gold in a fixed mark says *this is the institution*; gold in a generated surface would say *this was earned* — and would be a lie wherever nothing was.
- The exception is **not transitive**. Gold in the logo licenses gold **nowhere else**: not in buttons, not in navigation, not in charts, not in headers. Every rule above continues to apply to every pixel the product generates.
- Where the logo appears in the product, it appears **as the logo** — in the navigation bar, at its fixed size — never as a decorative element, never enlarged as ornament, never recoloured to tint a surface.

A designer who reads "the logo has gold, therefore gold is a brand colour" has misread this document. The logo is the institution's signature; gold in the interface is the professional's achievement. They are not the same thing, and they never mix.

5.4 Neutrals — Paper and Graphite

The Tool register lives here: clear, calm, spacious.

Token	Hex	Use
paper	#FFFFFF	Tool surfaces; cards
paper-warm	#FBFBFA	Application background (a touch of warmth; never clinical)
graphite-900	#14171C	Primary text (Tool register)

Token	Hex	Use
graphite-700	#3A4048	Secondary text
graphite-500	#6B7280	Muted text; captions
graphite-300	#C9CED6	Borders; dividers
graphite-100	#EEF0F3	Subtle fills; skeletons

5.5 Functional Colours

Restrained, institutional, never alarming. These are the colours of a status report, not of a game.

Token	Hex	Meaning
verified	#1F7A5C	Verified, corroborated, confirmed. A deep, sober green — never a bright "success" green.
attention	#B4791E	Requires attention; ageing competence. Amber, not orange.
critical	#A02B2B	Revoked, failed verification. Deep and grave — never a screaming red.
information	#2C5892	Neutral information (navy-500).

Rule. Functional colour **MUST NOT** be used to express *judgement of a person*. An under-evidenced competence is attention, never critical — because the person has not failed; the evidence is simply thin (§14.5).

5.6 Accessibility

- Body text **MUST** meet **WCAG AA** (contrast $\geq 4.5:1$); large text and UI components $\geq 3:1$.
- The system **SHOULD** target **AAA** ($\geq 7:1$) for primary reading text. graphite-900 on paper achieves this.
- Meaning **MUST NOT** be carried by colour alone. Every state that uses colour also carries a label, an icon, or a shape. A colour-blind professional loses no information.
- Gold on navy: use gold-400 (not gold-500) for text, to hold contrast on dark ground.

6. Typography

6.1 The Three Voices

Opus X speaks in three typographic voices, each with a strict domain.

The Institutional Voice — Serif. Used for the **Passport object** and for institutional statements (the vision statement, certification titles, the Passport's own headings). A transitional serif carries the authority of documents that matter: diplomas, charters,

constitutions. *Typeface: Source Serif 4* (or an equivalent transitional serif with a permanent, non-fashionable skeleton).

The Interface Voice — Sans. Used for the **Tool register**: navigation, controls, labels, tables, forms, help. A neutral grotesque that disappears in service of the content. *Typeface: Inter.*

The Engraved Voice — Mono. Used for the **Opus ID**, hashes, identifiers, and any value whose exactness matters. The Opus ID is *engraved*, not written — monospace, tracked out, tabular figures. *Typeface: IBM Plex Mono* (or JetBrains Mono).

A fourth voice exists, and it is not one of these: the wordmark. The Opus X wordmark is set in a geometric sans and is a **fixed artifact** (§7.2) — vectorised once, placed, never typeset. It is **not** a typographic voice of the system, and its typeface **MUST NOT** be used anywhere else in the interface. A logo is not a font.

6.2 The Scale

A restrained modular scale. A designer **MUST NOT** introduce a size outside it.

Token	Size / Line-height	Use
display	48 / 56	The Passport's title; ceremony
h1	32 / 40	Page titles
h2	24 / 32	Section titles
h3	19 / 28	Card titles; sub-sections
body-lg	17 / 28	Institutional statements; reading text
body	15 / 24	Default interface text
body-sm	13 / 20	Secondary; captions
micro	11 / 16	Labels; metadata; overline (tracked +0.12em, uppercase)

6.3 Weights

Three weights only: **Regular (400)**, **Medium (500)**, **Semibold (600)**. Bold (700+) is not used — emphasis by weight is a shout, and Opus X does not shout. Light weights are not used: they read as fashion, not as institution.

6.4 Numbers

- All figures in tables, indices, and data **MUST** be **tabular** (font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums). Columns of numbers must align on the decimal.
- Indices are rendered in the **interface voice**, never the serif — a measure is not an institution.

- A number **MUST NOT** be styled for drama: no oversized counts, no colour-coded scores, no animated counting-up. A number states; it does not perform.

6.5 Tables

Tables are a first-class citizen of an evidence-based product, not an afterthought.

- Header row: micro, uppercase, tracked, graphite-500.
- Row separators: 1px graphite-100 — **never** zebra striping (which adds visual noise without meaning).
- Alignment: text left, numbers right, dates right.
- Density: comfortable by default (44px row height). Compact mode MAY be offered; cramped is never the default.

7. The Logo System

Adopted 2026-07-13. This chapter records the mark as it exists; it does not propose one.

7.1 The Mark

The Opus X symbol is an **X within a broken circle**.

- **The X** is the intersection of **human potential** and **verified evidence** — the two things whose meeting is the entire purpose of this ecosystem. It is drawn in two materials: one arm **silver**, one arm **gold**. Potential and proof, crossing.
- **The circle** is **integrity, continuity, and the global reach of trust** — a form with no beginning and no end.
- **The circle is broken where the X crosses it**. This is the mark's most important property, and it is not decorative: *the evidence interrupts the circle*. An unbroken ring would be a promise; a ring traversed by proof is a fact.
- **The X extends beyond the circle**. Competence is not contained by the institution that verifies it.

The mark carries metallic gradients — gold and silver as *materials*, not as flat colour. This gives the mark the weight of an object rather than the flatness of a graphic, consistent with the Law of the Object (§10).

7.2 The Wordmark

OPUS X, set in a **geometric sans** with wide tracking. OPUS in white (on dark grounds) or navy (on light grounds); the **X in gold** — the only letterform in the system permitted to carry gold, because it is the mark's own letter.

The wordmark is a **fixed artifact**, drawn and vectorised once. It is **not typeset**: a designer never re-sets it in the interface typefaces (§6). It is placed, never composed.

7.3 The Tagline

TRUSTED. VERIFIED. PROVEN.

Set in the geometric sans, gold, wide tracking, beneath the wordmark, above a fine gold rule.

Scope — normative. The tagline belongs to **brand contexts only**: the primary logo, brand documents, signage, presentation covers, social sharing images. It **MUST NOT** appear in the product interface — not on the landing page, not in the navigation, not on the Passport, not in any generated surface. *Professionalism before Marketing* (§3.4) governs the product; the tagline is a brand signature, not a product claim.

7.4 The Logo and the Seal Are Different Marks

This distinction is the most consequential in this chapter, and misreading it would corrupt the entire trust-visualization discipline.

	The Logo	The Seal
What it is	The institution's signature	The mark of earned trust
Form	X within a broken circle	A circle enclosing a single point
Where it appears	Navigation, brand contexts, favicon	On the Passport, on certifications, on verified evidence
When it appears	Always — it is the brand	Only where something has been proven
What it says	<i>This is Opus X</i>	<i>This was earned</i>

The seal is **not** a small version of the logo, and the logo is **not** a large version of the seal. They are different marks, they carry different meanings, and they are governed by different rules. The seal is bound by §5.3's gold discipline absolutely: it appears only where trust has been earned. The logo is the bounded exception (§5.3).

A Passport bears the **seal**. The navigation bar bears the **logo**. They are never substituted for one another.

7.5 Favicon and Small Sizes

The symbol alone, never the full lockup. At 32px, a wordmark becomes illegible noise; the symbol remains readable to 16px.

The wordmark **MUST NOT** be reproduced below **96px** in width.

7.6 Clear Space

The mark **MUST** be surrounded by clear space equal to **one quarter of the symbol's height** on all sides. Nothing enters this zone — not text, not borders, not imagery.

7.7 Prohibited Uses

The mark **MUST NOT** be: rotated, stretched, skewed, re-proportioned, recoloured outside its adopted palette, outlined, given a drop shadow or glow beyond its own material rendering, placed on a busy or low-contrast image, animated with bounce, spin, or scale, reconstructed from primitives (it is a fixed artifact — it is placed, never redrawn), or used in place of the seal (§7.4).

7.8 Asset Registry

Asset	Use
logo-dark	Full lockup — dark grounds
logo-light	Full lockup — light grounds
lockup-horizontal-dark / -light	Navigation bars, headers
symbol-dark / -light	Symbol alone
icon.png · apple-icon.png	Favicon, iOS icon (symbol on navy)
icon-192 · icon-512	PWA
og-image	Social sharing (1200×630)

Pending. The mark is currently held as raster assets (1254px source). **Vectorisation to SVG is required** before print, engraving, or any reproduction above screen scale — and before the identity can be considered permanent. This is recorded as an open item, not a defect.

8. Iconography

- **Style:** line icons, geometric, drawn on a 24×24 grid.
- **Stroke:** 1.5px, constant. No variable weights, no tapering.
- **Corners:** 2px radius on joins; terminals are square-cut, not rounded (roundness reads as friendly-consumer; we are institutional).
- **Fill:** icons are never filled, except a single case: the **seal**, which is the only solid mark in the system.
- **Colour:** icons inherit text colour. An icon **MUST NOT** be gold unless it is a trust or certification mark.
- **Prohibitions:** no illustrated icons, no duotone, no emoji, no icon with a personality (no winking, no faces, no mascots).

9. Space, Grid, and Elevation

9.1 Space

Base unit: **4px**. Scale: 4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 24 · 32 · 48 · 64 · 96 · 128.

Breathing rule. In the Tool register, the vertical rhythm between major blocks **MUST** be at least 48px, and a dashboard's primary surfaces **SHOULD** be separated by 64px or more. *Space is the message: an interface that breathes signals a product that is certain of itself, and an empty state that breathes reads as potential rather than as failure (§12.5).*

9.2 Grid

12-column, 1200px max content width for application surfaces; 720px max for reading surfaces. The Passport object is centred and never exceeds 640px in width — a document has a page, not a viewport.

9.3 Radius

- Tool surfaces: **8px**.
- Object surfaces (the Passport): **16px** — a heavier, more physical curve.
- Buttons and inputs: **6px**.
- Nothing is fully rounded (pill shapes) except a single case: a status dot. Pills read as consumer-app; we do not use them for buttons or tags.

9.4 Elevation

Elevation is used with extreme restraint.

- **Tool register:** flat by default. A card is defined by a 1px graphite-300 border, not a shadow. One shadow level exists for overlays and modals: 0 4px 24px rgba(10,22,40,0.08).
 - **Object register:** the Passport carries real depth — 0 24px 64px rgba(5,11,21,0.45) — because it is an object with mass. This is the **only** place in the system where a strong shadow is permitted.
-

Part III — The Interface

10. The Two Registers: Object and Tool

This is the most important structural rule of the visual system, and it is inherited from the product philosophy (PRODUCT-000 §2; the *Law of the Object*).

	OBJECT — the Passport	TOOL — the Dashboard and application
What it is	An official asset. A passport, a diploma, a certificate.	An instrument. Sober, calm, administrative.
Ground	Deep navy (navy-900/950)	Paper (paper-warm)
Voice	Institutional serif; engraved mono	Interface sans
Depth	Real material shadow; mass	Flat; 1px borders
Gold	The seal, present	Absent (except a verification mark)
Motion	Slow, ceremonial (§16)	Immediate, unobtrusive
Feeling	<i>I have received something.</i>	<i>I am in control.</i>

Normative rules.

- The Passport **MUST NOT** be rendered as a SaaS card. It never "pops" into existence; it is **forged** or revealed with weight (§16.3).
- The two registers **MUST NOT** be mixed within a single element. A dashboard card that shows the Passport is a **window onto the object**, rendered in the object's register, seated within the tool's.
- The tool **MUST** recede. It is the frame; the Passport is the picture.

11. UI Components

11.1 Cards (Tool)

Surface paper, 1px graphite-300 border, 8px radius, 24px internal padding, no shadow. A card title is h3. A card **MUST NOT** carry a coloured header bar, an accent stripe, or an illustration.

11.2 Buttons

Variant	Treatment	Use
Primary	navy-600 fill, paper text, 6px radius	The single most important action on a surface
Secondary	paper fill, 1px graphite-300 border, graphite-900 text	Supporting actions
Quiet	No fill, no border, navy-500 text	Tertiary; inline actions
Object	gold-500 at 10% opacity fill, 1px gold-500/30% border, gold-400 text	Only on the Passport object, and only for the single ceremonial CTA

Rules. One primary button per surface. Buttons **MUST NOT** be gold in the Tool register. A disabled button is 35% opacity — never a different colour. There are no gradient buttons, no glow, no scale-on-hover beyond 1.00 (hover changes colour, not size).

11.3 Inputs

paper fill, 1px graphite-300 border, 6px radius, 44px height minimum. Focus: 1px navy-500 border plus a 2px navy-500/15% ring. Errors: 1px critical border plus a message — **never** a red fill, which reads as punishment.

11.4 Badges and Status

A status is a **dot plus a label**, never a coloured pill. The dot is 6px; the label is micro, uppercase, tracked.

Status	Dot	Label
Verified	verified	VERIFIED
Establishing	graphite-500	ESTABLISHING
Ageing	attention	NEEDS RENEWAL
Revoked	critical	REVOKED
Certified	gold-500	CERTIFIED

11.5 Alerts

Alerts are **quiet**. A 1px left border in the functional colour, a paper ground, body-sm text. No icons-in-circles, no coloured backgrounds, no dismissible toasts that shout. An alert informs; it never alarms.

11.6 Navigation

A single top bar (64px, paper, 1px bottom border). Logo left; the professional's name and Opus ID (in micro mono, graphite-500) right, with a minimal account menu. **No sidebar in Sprint-1-class applications** — a sidebar implies a feature-dense product, and density is not what we sell. When a sidebar becomes necessary, it is 240px, paper-warm, borderless, with body-sm labels and no icons-only mode.

11.7 Charts

- Chart ink is navy-500; a second series is navy-300; a **verified** series MAY be gold-500.
- No gradients under lines. No 3D. No pie charts (they defeat comparison). No animation on load beyond a 200ms fade.
- Axes are graphite-300, 1px; gridlines are horizontal only, graphite-100.
- Every chart **MUST** be readable without colour.

11.8 Modals

Centred, max 560px, paper, 8px radius, the single permitted shadow. The backdrop is navy-950 at 40% opacity — never pure black. Modals are used sparingly: an interface that constantly interrupts is not a calm one.

12. Dashboard Principles

12.1 The Canonical Descent

Every Opus X dashboard follows one movement, and **never** its inverse:

Overview → Detail → Evidence

The professional first sees *where they stand* (overview), then *what composes it* (detail), then *what proves it* (evidence). This is the visual expression of *Evidence before Opinion*: the interface always allows the descent from a claim to its ground.

An interface that presents evidence first would overwhelm; one that presents *only* an overview, with no descent available, would be an oracle — and the product is never an oracle (§15).

12.2 Hierarchy

The Passport is dominant. The status modules are subordinate and equal among themselves. There is exactly one focal point per screen.

12.3 Density

Deliberately low. A dashboard **MUST** breathe (§9.1). Adding a module requires removing one, or justifying the loss of calm.

12.4 Loading

Per-module skeletons in graphite-100 — **never** a global spinner. A spinner says *the system is thinking*; a skeleton says *your content is arriving*. If one module fails, it shows an isolated, quiet retry state; it never breaks the surface.

12.5 Empty States

An empty Passport must feel ready, never failed. This is a normative requirement of the highest order.

- An empty state **MUST** explain what will arrive and how.
- An empty state **MUST NOT** display a zero as a judgement (0/100), an empty progress bar, a sad illustration, or a dead button.
- A qualitative state (*Establishing*) **MUST** be preferred to a quantitative zero (§14.3).
- The lifecycle trajectory **SHOULD** be shown, so that emptiness reads as **a promise of progression** rather than an absence.

13. The Professional Passport

The Passport is the product (PRODUCT-000 §2). Everything in this system exists to make it credible.

13.1 Its Appearance

The Passport is a **document with mass**. It is rendered on navy-900, with a subtle vertical gradient toward navy-800 (the fall of light on material), a 1px navy-700 border, 16px radius, and the system's single permitted deep shadow (§9.4). Its width never exceeds 640px.

13.2 The Seal

A single gold mark, top-right: a circle enclosing a point. It is the only solid element in the iconography. It is present from the moment of issuance — because the Passport is *issued by Opus X*, and the seal is what says so.

13.3 The Opus ID

Engraved. Mono, tracked +0.08em, navy-200 (or graphite-300 on light). It is never truncated, never copied to the clipboard with fanfare, never decorated. Beneath it, in body-sm, the statement of permanence.

The Opus ID is the professional's signature for life. It is treated with the gravity of an engraving on a monument, not the levity of a username.

13.4 The Lifecycle

The Passport's seven lifecycle stages are **always present**, from the first second of its existence. The current stage is marked in gold-500; future stages in navy-700.

Future stages are rendered as **a desirable trajectory, never as empty checkboxes**. The Passport is a living object that will accompany a career; showing only where it is today would make it a certificate, and it is not a certificate — it is an *open document*.

13.5 Priority of Information

The Passport shows, in this order of visual authority:

1. **What is proven** — demonstrated competence, certifications, verified evidence.
2. **Where the professional stands** — lifecycle stage, qualitative status.
3. **What is inferred** — the indices, always visually subordinate to the facts (§14.6).

13.6 Sharing and Consultation

- A shared Passport is rendered in the **same object register** as the private one. The recipient sees the object, not a "public profile page." The Passport does not have a marketing version of itself.
- A consulted Passport **MUST** display, adjacent to any certification, the **issuer** and the **verification affordance**. Trust is never asserted; it is always checkable.
- What is not disclosed is **absent**, not blurred or teased. A locked padlock over hidden content would advertise what the professional chose to withhold — a violation of subject control's spirit.

14. Trust Visualization

This chapter is the most sensitive in the system. It is where the protocol's deepest invariant becomes visible.

14.1 Indices Are a Language, Not a Verdict

Trust Index, Skills Index, Readiness, Growth, Coverage, Freshness — these are **instruments of understanding**, and they **MUST** read as such. A professional reads them the way an engineer reads a set of gauges: with interest and agency, never with the anxiety of being graded.

14.2 The Canonical Rendering

Each index is rendered as: a **label** (micro, uppercase), a **value or qualitative state** (interface sans), a **restrained visualization** (a horizontal bar, a sparkline, or nothing), and an **affordance to open it to its evidence**.

The bar: 4px height, graphite-100 track, navy-500 fill. A verified or certified component **MAY** be gold-500. There is no gradient, no glow, no animated fill.

14.3 Qualitative Before Quantitative

Where an index is not yet meaningfully established, the interface **MUST** show a **qualitative state** (*Establishing, Emerging, Established*) and **MUST NOT** show a numeric zero. A 0/100 on a new professional's first screen is a small act of cruelty and a large lie: they have not scored zero; they have simply not yet demonstrated.

14.4 Prohibitions — Absolute

The following **MUST NOT** appear anywhere in the Opus X ecosystem:

- **No gamification.** No points, no levels-as-rewards, no streaks, no confetti, no celebration animations.
- **No trophies, badges-as-achievements, or medals.** A certification is an institutional fact, rendered as a fact — not a prize.
- **No leaderboards. No ranking of persons. Ever.**
- **No progress bar toward "completing" a professional.** A person is not a completion percentage.
- **No score of a human being's worth.** There is no such number in the system, so there is none to display.

14.5 Gaps Are Paths, Not Deficiencies

A missing competence is rendered as **an available path**, in navy-300 with a route to the mission that would demonstrate it — never as a red gap, a warning, or a deficit. The visual language of a gap is *opportunity*, and the functional colour critical is **forbidden** for gaps (§5.5).

14.6 Fact and Interpretation Are Visually Distinct

This is the visual expression of the protocol's defining discipline (WSP-001 §14), and it is normative.

	Fact (evidence, certification, attestation)	Interpretation (index, level, freshness)
Weight	Primary — full text colour	Subordinate — graphite-500 / navy-300
Position	Above, or to the left	Below, or to the right
Mark	MAY carry the gold seal	Never gold
Affordance	Verifiable — shows issuer, date, signature	Openable — resolves to the facts beneath it
Label	Stated plainly	Always framed as a read: " <i>Based on 4 pieces of evidence...</i> "

A professional **MUST** be able to tell, at a glance and without reading a legend, what they have *proven* from what the system *infers*. An interface that blurred this line would

be dishonest at its core — and would forfeit the trust the entire ecosystem exists to provide.

15. The AI Experience

AI in Opus X is a **copilot, never an oracle** (PRODUCT-600). The visual system enforces this.

15.1 The Four Registers of AI Speech

Every AI output **MUST** be visually typed as one of four kinds, and never presented ambiguously:

Register	Visual treatment	Example
Fact	Standard text authority; verifiable	"You completed 4 missions in Q2."
Interpretation	Subordinate weight; openable to evidence ; framed as a read	"Based on this evidence, your retrieval competence reads as Proficient."
Recommendation	Marked as suggestion; always dismissible; never imperative	"Demonstrating X would close the gap to this role."
Prediction	Marked as uncertain, with its basis stated — and forbidden where the evidence does not support it	"Confidence is low: only one piece of evidence."

15.2 Rules

- An AI output **MUST** carry a visible affordance to see *why* — the path to its evidence (MODEL-002 §4.2).
 - The AI **MUST NOT** be rendered with a personality: no avatar, no face, no name, no conversational chirpiness, no typing-dots theatre.
 - The AI **MUST NOT** be given the visual authority of an institution: it does not use the serif voice, and it never carries the seal.
 - Uncertainty **MUST** be shown, not hidden. An honest "I don't have enough evidence" is a feature of the design, not a failure of it.
-

Part IV — Expression

16. Motion

16.1 The Principle

Movement must inspire mastery. Motion in Opus X is slow, deliberate, and almost imperceptible. Nothing bounces. Nothing springs. Nothing celebrates.

16.2 The Values

Motion	Duration	Easing
Micro-interaction (hover, focus)	150ms	ease-out
Surface transition (page, modal)	300ms	cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1)
Object reveal (the Passport)	1200-2000ms	ease-out
Ceremony (the forge)	Per-step 1200-1600ms	linear reveal, ease-out fade

16.3 The Ceremony — The One Exception

The issuance of the Passport is the **only** place in the ecosystem where motion is permitted to be *felt*. The object does not appear; it **materializes** — emerging from blur and translation into focus over ~2 seconds, as something being forged.

Even here, there is no fanfare: no confetti, no sound, no burst, no sparkle. The gravity of the moment comes from **slowness and inevitability**, not from spectacle. *An institution does not celebrate; it confers.*

16.4 Prohibitions

No parallax. No scroll-jacking. No auto-playing video. No animated gradients. No skeleton shimmer that races. No number counting-up. No element that moves to attract attention.

17. Photography

Photography is used sparingly and only where it grounds the product in reality.

Permitted subjects: real professionals at real work (hands, tools, screens, workshops, trading floors, laboratories, sites); **architecture** (institutional, structural, permanent); **technology** as material (servers, cables, instruments); **documents** (paper, seals, ink, archives); **texture** (stone, linen, metal, paper grain).

Treatment: desaturated toward the navy end; high dynamic range in shadow; never over-lit. Photography **SHOULD** feel observed, not staged.

Absolute prohibitions: no stock-photo corporate clichés — no handshakes, no diverse-team-laughing-at-laptop, no thumbs-up, no arms-crossed executives against white, no lens flares, no people looking directly at camera smiling. If an image would be at home on a bank's homepage circa 2014, it is disqualified.

18. Illustration

Illustration is **technical only**. Its purpose is to explain structure, never to charm.

Permitted: the Knowledge Graph; Framework structures; Evidence graphs; the Professional Network; protocol and architecture diagrams.

Style: line-based, navy-* monochrome with a single gold-500 accent where trust is depicted; the same geometric language as the iconography; no gradients; no depth; no perspective tricks.

Absolute prohibitions: no mascots, no characters, no blob-people, no isometric-startup illustrations, no hand-drawn warmth, no 3D renders, no abstract "AI brain" imagery.

19. Tone of Visual Communication

19.1 The Six Notes

Every surface must sound like: **Institution · Luxury · Technology · Trust · Calm · Precision.**

Luxury here means *restraint and material quality*, never opulence. Technology means *precision*, never futurism. Institution means *permanence*, never bureaucracy.

19.2 The Test

Before shipping any surface, ask: *Would this be at home in the annual report of a central bank, and equally at home in the interface of the world's most precise technology company?* If it belongs to only one of the two, it is not yet Opus X.

19.3 Language

The visual system inherits the **locked lexicon** (PRODUCT-000; the Sprint-1 constants module). A Passport is **issued**, never *created*. An identity is **established**, never *signed up for*. The interface never says "*account*". These are not preferences; they are a test that fails the build.

Part V — Governance

20. Conformance

20.1 Binding Scope

From adoption, every mockup, component, screen, dashboard, and application in the ecosystem **MUST** conform to this document — including partner applications rendering Passport data (which inherit the trust-visualization rules of §14 without exception).

20.2 Conformance Review

A surface conforms when:

- It uses **only** the tokens of Annex A.
- It respects the **two registers** (§10) without mixing them.
- Gold is **scarce and semantic** (§5.3).
- Facts and interpretations are **visually distinct** (§14.6).
- **No prohibition of Annex B** is present.
- Empty states read as **ready, never failed** (§12.5).
- It passes the test of §19.2.

20.3 Evolution

This document evolves **only through controlled versioning**. A change to the palette, the typographic voices, the two registers, or the prohibitions of §14.4 is a **major version** and requires the same deliberation as a protocol change. Additive components are minor versions.

21. The Golden Rule

Everything in this document — every hex value, every millisecond of easing, every removed pixel — exists to serve a single sentence. When a decision is uncertain, this is the arbiter:

Every interface must make the user feel that their professional identity has finally found a trusted home.

Home, because it belongs to them and will remain. *Trusted*, because it can be verified. *Finally*, because no one has ever given them this before.

Annex A — Design Tokens

```
/* — Colour — */
--navy-950: #050B15; --navy-900: #0A1628; --navy-800: #0F2038;
--navy-700: #16304F; --navy-600: #1E4272; --navy-500: #2C5892;
--navy-400: #5081BC; --navy-300: #8FB0D8; --navy-200: #C2D6EC;
--navy-100: #E4EDF7; --navy-50: #F4F8FC;

--gold-700: #8A6D2F; --gold-600: #A88A42; --gold-500: #C9A961;
--gold-400: #DDC489; --gold-300: #EBDCB4; --gold-100: #F7F1E2;

--paper: #FFFFFF; --paper-warm: #FBFBFA;
--graphite-900: #14171C; --graphite-700: #3A4048;
--graphite-500: #6B7280; --graphite-300: #C9CED6;
--graphite-100: #EEF0F3;

--verified: #1F7A5C; --attention: #B4791E;
--critical: #A02B2B; --information: #2C5892;

/* — Typography — */
--font-institutional: 'Source Serif 4', Georgia, serif;
--font-interface: 'Inter', system-ui, sans-serif;
--font-engraved: 'IBM Plex Mono', ui-monospace, monospace;

/* — Space (base 4) — */
--space-1: 4px; --space-2: 8px; --space-3: 12px; --space-4: 16px;
--space-6: 24px; --space-8: 32px; --space-12: 48px; --space-16: 64px;
--space-24: 96px; --space-32: 128px;

/* — Radius — */
--radius-control: 6px; --radius-surface: 8px; --radius-object: 16px;

/* — Elevation — */
--shadow-overlay: 0 4px 24px rgba(10, 22, 40, 0.08);
--shadow-object: 0 24px 64px rgba(5, 11, 21, 0.45);

/* — Motion — */
--motion-micro: 150ms; --motion-surface: 300ms;
--motion-object: 1600ms;
--ease-institutional: cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1);
```

Annex B — Prohibitions (Quick Reference)

Never, anywhere in the Opus X ecosystem:

X	A score of a person's worth
X	A ranking or leaderboard of persons
X	Gamification: points, streaks, levels-as-rewards, confetti
X	Trophies, medals, achievement badges
X	A numeric zero where a qualitative state belongs (0/100)
X	A gap rendered as a failure (red, warning, deficit)
X	Facts and interpretations rendered alike
X	Gold used decoratively, or for anything not earned (<i>the brand mark is the single bounded exception — §5.3, §7</i>)
X	The Passport rendered as a SaaS card
X	The AI given a face, a name, or institutional authority
X	Corporate stock photography; smiling teams; handshakes
X	Mascots, characters, blob-people, isometric startup art
X	Bounce, spring, parallax, scroll-jacking, counting-up numbers
X	Celebration animation (even at issuance — gravity, not fanfare)
X	Pill-shaped buttons, gradient buttons, glow, 3D (<i>in the interface — the brand mark's own material rendering is not an interface element</i>)
X	The tagline in any product surface (<i>brand contexts only — §7.3</i>)
X	The logo used in place of the seal, or the seal in place of the logo (§7.4)
X	The words <i>create</i> , <i>sign up</i> , or <i>account</i>

References

Informative References

- PRODUCT-000 — Product Philosophy (§2 the Passport is the product; §4 the first two minutes; §5 the product principles; §6 invariants as experience)
- PRODUCT-100 — The Professional Passport; PRODUCT-101 — Passport Dashboard & Cards; PRODUCT-110 — The First Two Minutes; PRODUCT-500 — The Trust

Intelligence Experience (§5 the line that is never crossed); PRODUCT-600 — The AI Copilot Experience

- OPUS-000 — Opus X: The Professional Knowledge Infrastructure; OPUS-300 — Professional Trust Intelligence (§6 the hard limits)
- ARCH-001 — Evidence Is Produced. Trust Is Verified.; FOUNDATION-000 — The Trust Manifesto
- WSP-001 — Core Objects and Semantics (§14 the fact/interpretation boundary); MODEL-002 — Trust and Interpretation Model (§4.2 explainability; §5 the limits)